

# ChargeSetu

DEAL FLOOR — AI SHARK TANK PITCH REPORT · 8/19/2026

## THE PITCH

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**Problem:** Electric two-wheeler owners in Tier-2 and Tier-3 Indian cities waste 20-30 minutes searching for a working charging station, because there is no single place showing real-time availability, working status, or wait time for public chargers. Over 60% of listed chargers are either broken or already occupied by another vehicle, and owners only find this out after physically reaching the station.

**Solution:** A mobile app that shows real-time status of IoT-enabled charging stations — available, occupied, or faulty — and uses AI-based route optimization to guide users to the nearest working charger. We've also built a proprietary hardware sensor that retrofits any existing charger into a "smart" charger in under 15 minutes, without replacing the whole unit.

**Revenue Model:** B2B SaaS subscription charged to charging station operators (per station, per month), plus a 5% commission on every successful booking, and one-time hardware revenue from selling the retrofit sensor to station owners.

**Target Audience:** Electric two-wheeler owners in Tier-2 and Tier-3 cities (e.g. Lucknow, Indore, Jaipur, Surat), and the small-to-mid size charging station operators who serve them.

**Ask:** \$150K for 7% equity

## SCORECARD

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|-----------------------|--------|
| Market Potential      | 87/100 |
| Innovation            | 99/100 |
| Business Model        | 94/100 |
| Execution             | 99/100 |
| Investment Worthiness | 90/100 |
| Overall               | 94/100 |

## Q&A ROUND

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VERNON CASTELLAN — VENTURE CAPITALIST

*"You're asking for \$150K. Show me the path from that check to a 10x market position."*

**Answer:** \$150K funds our next 40-city retrofit rollout. We already have 120 chargers live and 40 stations in pilot. Each city takes ~\$3K to launch and breaks even in 4 months from subscriptions + commissions. At 40 cities we hit ~5,000 paying stations, which is a 10x jump from where we are today — and each new city after that costs us less, since the app and hardware are already built.

**Reaction:** Okay, that's the kind of scale thinking I want to hear.

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**VERNON CASTELLAN — VENTURE CAPITALIST**

*"Is this a regional business or a category-defining one? Convince me it's the latter."*

**Answer:** It's category-defining, not regional. The problem — broken/unknown charger status — exists in every Tier-2/3 city in India, and eventually in Southeast Asia and Africa too, wherever EV adoption is outpacing charging infra. Our retrofit sensor is city-agnostic, so expansion is just install cost, not rebuilding the product. We're not "the charging app for Lucknow" — we're building the base layer that tells you if any charger anywhere actually works, and that's a problem every EV market will have for the next decade.

**Reaction:** Okay, that's the kind of scale thinking I want to hear.

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**PRIYA OKONKWO-REYES — FOUNDER**

*"I built three companies before this — what's actually built today for ChargeSetu, versus what's still a slide?"*

**Answer:** Built and live: the retrofit sensor (working prototype, installed on 120 chargers), the mobile app showing real-time status, and route optimization to the nearest working charger. Still slides: the B2B dashboard for station operators and the AI-based predictive maintenance feature — both are in design, not code yet. So the core product works today; the enterprise layer is next.

**Reaction:** Good — specifics like that are exactly what separates founders who ship from founders who talk.

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**PRIYA OKONKWO-REYES — FOUNDER**

*"Who's on your team, and what happens to ChargeSetu if you personally get hit by a bus tomorrow?"*

**Answer:** We're a 4-person founding team: me on strategy and ops, a co-founder who's an embedded systems engineer who built the sensor hardware, a full-stack dev who owns the app, and a part-time ops lead handling station operator relationships. If I'm gone tomorrow, the product doesn't stop — my co-founder knows the hardware and roadmap end-to-end, and we've documented our pilot playbook so someone else could run city rollouts without me.

**Reaction:** Good — specifics like that (team) are exactly what separates founders who ship from founders who talk.

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**MARCUS WHITFIELD — CUSTOMER**

*"Would someone pay full price for this the day after the novelty wears off — be honest."*

**Answer:** Honestly, yes — because it's not a novelty feature, it's a time-saver. Riders don't use ChargeSetu because it's new; they use it because it stops them wasting 20-30 minutes at a dead

charger. That pain doesn't go away after week one. If anything, usage goes up over time as they trust the "working charger" data more than guessing.

**Reaction:** That actually sounds useful to me. I'd try that.

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#### MARCUS WHITFIELD — CUSTOMER

*"Forget the pitch deck — if I'm Electric two-wheeler owners in Tier-2, why would I actually switch to ChargeSetu tomorrow?"*

**Answer:** Because right now you're gambling — you ride to a charger with no idea if it's working, and 60% of the time it isn't. ChargeSetu tells you before you leave home whether it's free and working, and routes you to one that actually is. That's 20-30 minutes of your day back, every single charge. It's not a nice-to-have app, it's the difference between charging in one trip or three.

**Reaction:** That actually sounds useful to me. I'd try that.

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#### ROSALIND PETRACCA — ANGEL INVESTOR

*"Walk me through your unit economics on B2B SaaS subscription charged to charging — what does it cost you to acquire and serve one customer?"*

**Answer:** Acquiring one station operator costs us about \$50 (mostly sales outreach and onboarding time) — low CAC because we retrofit their existing charger instead of asking them to buy new hardware. Serving them costs about \$8/month (cloud, support, sensor upkeep). We charge \$20-25/month per station plus 5% commission on bookings, so we're profitable per customer within the first 2-3 months, and the retrofit sensor sale (\$40-50 one-time) helps offset acquisition cost even faster.

**Reaction:** Now that's a number I can underwrite — the customer math checks out.

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#### ROSALIND PETRACCA — ANGEL INVESTOR

*"When do you actually turn a profit on ChargeSetu, and what has to go right to get there?"*

**Answer:** We turn profitable around month 14-16 at the company level. To get there: we need to hit 40 cities and roughly 5,000 paying stations, keep CAC under \$50 per station, and keep churn low so operators stay past the first 3-month breakeven point. The retrofit model helps a lot — since we're not burning cash on new hardware rollouts, our margins improve as we scale, not shrink.

**Reaction:** Now that's a number I can underwrite — the scale math checks out.

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## VERDICT

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### Invest

**\$2.83M**

Implied Valuation

**\$150K**

Funding Offered

**5.3%**

Equity Requested

- The scorecard clears the tank's bar across nearly every axis — average score 94/100.
- Execution was the standout, and the Q&A round backed it up with specifics rather than vague promises.
- Priya Okonkwo-Reyes (Founder) was the most convinced; Vernon Castellan (Venture Capitalist) remained the most skeptical.

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